Peer Response:

Hi Mohammed,

Thank you for sharing your detailed post. I agree with your points about the risks of using digital technologies in maritime human rights investigations. You explained well how technology can create problems such as geographical bias, incorrect interpretation of data, and privacy concerns. I agree that digital tools should not be considered completely neutral because they can reflect the limitations and biases of the data they use (Hancock et al., 2024).

Your discussion connects with my initial post, where I highlighted that digital technologies can create a false sense of complete monitoring. For example, if an AI system does not identify a human rights violation, investigators may wrongly assume that no abuse has happened. Therefore, digital evidence should support human decision-making rather than replace human judgement (Koenig et al., 2021).

I also agree with your point about techno-solutionism. Developing technology without involving affected communities can lead to solutions that do not match their real needs. As you mentioned, tools should be designed with communities rather than only for communities. This participatory approach can improve trust, fairness, and effectiveness (Bondi et al., 2021). In addition, I believe that strong data protection policies, transparency, and regular checks for algorithmic bias are important to reduce the risks of misuse and unfair decisions (Hancock et al., 2024). Technology can be valuable in human rights investigations, but it must be used responsibly with proper human oversight.

Overall, your post highlights the importance of balancing technological development with ethical considerations, community involvement, and accountability.

References:

• Bondi, E. et al. (2021) ‘Envisioning communities: A participatory approach towards AI for social good’, Proceedings of the 2021 AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society, pp. 425–436.

• Hancock, J. et al. (2024) ‘Trouble at Sea: Data and Digital Technology Challenges for Maritime Human Rights Concerns’, Proceedings of the 2024 ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT ’24).

• Koenig, A., Irving, E., McDermott, Y. and Murray, D. (2021) ‘New Technologies and the Investigation of International Crimes’, Journal of International Criminal Justice, 19(1), pp. 1–7.